Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦J

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥3

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 7 2 ♥ A 7 5 ♦ J 4 2 ♣ 6 5 3	
♠ 10 8 5 4 3 ♥ 10 8 3 ♦ K 10 ♣ 10 9 2	N W E S	♠ 9 6 ♥ 9 6 4 ♦ 7 6 5 3 ♣ Q J 8 7
	♠ A Q ♥ K Q J 2 ♦ A Q 9 8 ♣ A K 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 25 points.

NORTH has 9 points but no 5-card suit. He should make a positive response of 2NT.

SOUTH figures NORTH for 8 points and bids 6NT. If NORTH has significantly more than 8 it will be up to him to go to 7NT. But he doesn't.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 9 6 5 ♥ 10 9 7 4 ♦ Q 5 3 ♣ Q 3	
♠ K Q J 8 2 ♥ A 5 ♦ A K 2 ♣ A K 2		♠ 7 ♥ K Q J 8 3 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 8 7 4
	♠ 10 4 3 ♥ 6 ♦ J 10 7 4 ♣ J 10 9 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♥	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East
Lead: ♦J

WEST opens 2♣ and EAST, with 8 points should bid 2♥.

WEST should bid his ♠ suit at his second turn.

And EAST can only rebid the 6-card ♥s.

That's enough for WEST to hear. He bids 6♥, or, just as good, he might bid 6NT.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 8 7 ♥ A K Q 2 ♦ A K J 6 ♣ 6	
♠ 3 ♥ J 10 6 3 ♦ 9 8 4 ♣ J 10 8 4 2		♠ 9 6 4 2 ♥ 9 7 4 ♦ 10 5 3 ♣ A 9 7
	♠ A J 10 5 ♥ 8 5 ♦ Q 7 2 ♣ K Q 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣J

After NORTH's 2♣ opening, SOUTH bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. SOUTH actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

NORTH's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking SOUTH for a 4-card Major. SOUTH mentions his ♠s and NORTH bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now SOUTH adds his 12 points to NORTH's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 9 8 7 ♥ 7 3 ♦ Q 5 4 ♣ K Q 9 4	
♠ A K Q 6 3 ♥ A K 10 9 6 ♦ 10 6 ♣ A		♠ 2 ♥ Q J 5 2 ♦ 9 8 7 2 ♣ 10 7 6 3
	♠ J 5 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ A K J 3 ♣ J 8 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♥3

EAST has 3 points, so she responds 2♦ to WEST's opening 2♣ bid, then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when WEST bids 2♠.

However, when WEST then bids ♥s, EAST finds two more points and bids 4♥.